

RIP SINGLE PLAYER GAMES?

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Compared to other mediums of entertainment, video games are a relatively new medium. And for most of their existence, they've been mostly single player games, attempting to provide an enticing and engrossing single player narrative.

However, in recent years, the trend seems to be moving increasingly towards multiplayer games. For every single player that's released, we see at least two to three multiplayer games releasing. Although critically-acclaimed single player experiences like those in franchises like Mass Effect, Dragon Age, Fallout and The Elder Scrolls are still being created, released and are very successful, it's very rare to see another

game as focused on the single player narrative anymore.

So why is this? If we had to put it simply, people like playing together. Playing video games is a fun activity, and the experiences video games provide can be great for bonding, and no one can deny it's an exceptionally fun means of doing so. Another reason is that gamers would rather compete with actual human players rather than the AI. This was evident back from the time when Starcraft II went competitive and has carried over to the eSport era we're in right now. But these are only a few factors. Other things, such as the technical and hardware aspects are also important to consider here. One of the biggest factors of course is broadband internet going mainstream. It would make sense for games to take advantage of technology which connects

people together. You know what they say, the more the merrier.

This transition into multiplayer has been happening steadily over the past few years, with many mainstream titles incorporating multiplayer game modes into their repertoires. In fact, these days many games are actually questioned if they don't have multiplayer in them, because it's almost considered a must to ensure the longevity of the game, something many gamers consider to determine the worth of a game. To reinforce this point, it's noteworthy to mention that a large percentage of the people who bought Starcraft II and Call of Duty: Black Ops did so for the multiplayer aspect of those games, even though they have critically acclaimed single player campaigns.

The multiplayer that we're talking about here isn't restricted to actually